Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Title: Outcome-Based Performance SOP

Purpose:

The purpose of this SOP is to establish a standardized, transparent, and objective framework to measure productivity, performance, and accountability of Developer, Designers and other employees operating in an AI-assisted environment (using tools such as Cursor AI, Claude AI, ChatGPT etc.). This SOP ensures fair evaluation based on outcomes, quality, ownership, and business impact, rather than tool dependency or raw output volume.

Scope

This SOP applies to:

- Front-end, Back-end, Full Stack, Mobile Developers
- UI/UX and Graphic Designers
- Technical Managers
- Project Managers
- Human Resources

Core Principles:

1. AI tools are accelerators, not contributors.
2. Performance evaluation will be outcome-driven, not effort-driven.
3. Quality, predictability, and ownership take precedence over speed.
4. Accountability and understanding of delivered work are mandatory.
5. AI usage must enhance efficiency without compromising quality, security, or maintainability.

Definition of Productivity:

Productivity shall be defined as: (Delivered & Accepted Work × Quality × Predictability) ÷ Rework

Traditional metrics such as lines of code or hours logged shall not be used as primary productivity indicators.

Performance Framework Overview:

Performance shall be evaluated monthly based on five core pillars:

Pillar	Weight
Delivery & Predictability	25%
Quality & Stability	25%
Technical Ownership	20%
Collaboration & Communication	10%
Learning, Ethics & AI Usage Discipline	10%
Behavioral & Professional Conduct	10%

Pillar 1: Delivery & Predictability (25%)

Key Metrics

- Planned vs Delivered Tasks (%)
- On-time Completion Ratio
- Task Spillover Count
- Estimation Accuracy

Evaluation Criteria

- Realistic task estimation
- Early identification and communication of blockers
- Consistency in delivery commitments

Rating Guidelines

- 5: Highly predictable, proactive, consistently meets commitments
- 3: Delivers with occasional re-estimation or delays
- 1: Frequent misses, poor planning and visibility

Pillar 2: Quality & Stability (25%)

Key Metrics

- Post-release defect count
- Bug severity distribution (P0–P3)
- Reopen rate
- Code review rejection rate
- Test coverage and adherence to standards

Evaluation Criteria

- Ability to explain and justify implementation logic
- Stability of delivered features
- Effectiveness in debugging and fixing issues

Quality Indicators

- Confident ownership of AI-generated code indicates effective usage
- Inability to explain logic indicates misuse or over-dependence

Pillar 3: Technical Ownership (20%)

Key Metrics

- Feature/module ownership
- Production issue handling
- Documentation completeness
- Independence in task execution

Ownership Levels

- Level 1: Requires constant supervision
- Level 3: Independently delivers assigned tasks

- Level 5: Owns modules, mentors others, drives improvements

AI tools must not increase dependency on senior team members.

Pillar 4: Collaboration & Communication (10%)

Key Metrics

- Stand-up clarity and consistency
- Status reporting quality
- Cross-team collaboration
- Responsiveness and professional conduct

Designer-Specific Criteria

- Handling of feedback and iterations
- Design-to-development handoff clarity
- Alignment with functional requirements

Feedback Sources

- Project Manager
- Technical Manager
- Structured peer feedback (limited weight)

Pillar 5: Learning, Ethics & AI Usage Discipline (10%)

Permitted AI Usage

- Boilerplate code generation
- Syntax assistance
- Refactoring suggestions
- Documentation drafting

Prohibited or Risky Practices

- Blind copy-paste without understanding
- Security-unaware implementations
- Repeated regressions caused by AI-generated code

Key Metrics

- Participation in learning initiatives
- Knowledge sharing
- Compliance with AI usage guidelines
- Reduction in recurring errors

Pillar 6: Behavioral & Professional Conduct (HR-Driven – 10%)

This pillar evaluates professional behavior, workplace discipline, and organizational values compliance. This pillar is primarily owned by HR, with inputs from Project Managers and Functional Heads.

Key Metrics

- Workplace behavior and attitude

- Professional communication etiquette
- Team respect and inclusivity
- Response to feedback and corrective actions
- Compliance with company policies

Punctuality & Attendance Metrics

- Login/logout discipline
- Stand-up and meeting punctuality
- Leave adherence and approval compliance
- Unplanned absence frequency

Behavioral Rating Guidelines

- 5: Exemplary professionalism, role model behavior
- 3: Generally compliant with occasional lapses
- 1: Repeated behavioral or punctuality issues

Exclusions

Behavioral scoring shall not be influenced by personal bias, isolated incidents, or non-work-related factors. All scores must be evidence-based.

Monthly Evaluation Process

1. Weekly data collection by Project Managers and Tech Managers
2. Monthly score compilation using standardized scorecards
3. Cross-verification of technical and delivery metrics
4. HR consolidation and bias review
5. Final rating approval

Sample Monthly Scorecard Structure

Pillar	Score (1–5)	Weight	Weighted Score
Delivery & Predictability		25%	
Quality & Stability		25%	
Technical Ownership		20%	
Collaboration & Communication		10%	
Learning & AI Discipline		10%	
Behavioral & Professional Conduct		10%	
Total Score			

Roles and Responsibilities

Technical Manager

- Conduct monthly code and design reviews
- Validate technical understanding
- Identify AI dependency risks

Project Manager

- Track delivery commitments and estimations
- Ensure communication discipline
- Provide structured performance feedback

Human Resources

- Aggregate and normalize scores
- Monitor trends across months
- Ensure evaluation fairness and consistency

Anti-Gaming and Control Measures

- Random code walkthroughs
- Root Cause Analysis (RCA) ownership
- Production incident explanations
- Limited peer validation

Outcomes and Usage

This SOP enables:

- Transparent monthly performance ratings
- Pillar-wise improvement planning
- Clear justification for appraisals and promotions
- Objective visibility into AI-assisted productivity

Review and Revision

This SOP shall be reviewed quarterly and updated based on organizational maturity, tooling evolution, and feedback from stakeholders.